

The missing transparency layer for Indian UPI rewards — built on the insight that users do not struggle to compare rewards, they struggle to trust them.

- PRD
- Case Study
- Dataset Audit
- Figma Prototype
- Working MVP
- GitHub Repository
- Live App ↗

Gap 1 Anticipation Users do not know before paying whether a reward is possible on this transaction.	Gap 2 Delivery The reward exists in the backend but the user sees an unchanged balance after paying.	Gap 3 Status No visibility into whether a reward is pending, failed, or was never earned.	Gap 4 Explanation When a reward is missing, users receive no reason — every absence feels like a broken promise.
--	--	---	--

PROBLEM STATEMENT

Indian UPI rewards are failing to build the trust and payment habits they were designed to create — not because reward value is insufficient, but because the reward *experience* is systematically opaque.

Reward information is fragmented across T&Cs, FAQ pages, offer sections, and app-specific conditions. Users cannot predict eligibility, verify delivery, or understand failure. Every unexplained miss is a perceived broken promise.

"Rewards feel random. I never know if I'll get one, how much, or why I didn't."
— Composite from r/IndiaFinance community research

RESEARCH INSIGHTS

This project was grounded in Mixpanel funnel analysis across four funnels from a live RuPay credit card UPI product, synthesised with community research across r/IndiaFinance, r/CreditCardsIndia, and app store reviews.

95.4% of first transactors never discovered their reward in 30 days	157K reward events generated per month — invisible to users	83% repeat transaction rate when the reward loop is fully experienced
---	---	---

The data confirmed: the product works for the minority who find it. The challenge is not reward value — it is reward visibility and trust.

WHY EXISTING SOLUTIONS FAIL

Comparison tools address the wrong diagnosis. Users are not primarily struggling to compare — they are struggling to trust. A tool that shows reward rates before payment does not explain why the reward did not arrive after it. It solves one of four gaps.

Incumbent apps have a structural conflict of interest. PhonePe, GPay, and CRED cannot credibly serve as a neutral trust layer for their own reward programs. Their comparison features rank their own products and hide conditions that would lead users elsewhere.

Financial aggregators (BankBazaar, Paisabazaar) are broad comparison platforms optimised for acquisition traffic, not payment-moment transparency. They do not answer "why didn't I get my reward for the transaction I just made."

No existing product addresses all four trust gaps simultaneously with a neutral, non-commercial mandate.

SOLUTION OVERVIEW

RewardTrust is a reward transparency platform built around four core product experiences — one for each trust gap. It is not a payment app. It is not a cashback provider. It is the neutral information layer that makes rewards trustworthy.

- **Reward Preview** — Before any payment: ranked reward comparison in specific rupee amounts with all conditions shown inline.
- **Reward Confirmation** — After any payment: log a transaction and receive a clear reward status with a plain-language explanation.
- **Reward Status Tracker** — A live view of all pending and recent rewards across all payment methods with expected credit dates.
- **Reward Explainer** — When no reward arrives: one of five specific, accurate reasons why — converting a trust-break into a learnable rule.

DESIGN PRINCIPLES

Rupees, not percentages
A user at a checkout queue cannot perform mental arithmetic. "₹22 back" requires none. "5%" requires calculation. Every result is shown in rupee amounts.

Conditions visible before the decision
All eligibility conditions are displayed inline — not behind a click, not in a modal. A user who discovers a disqualifying condition after paying has been failed by the product.

PRODUCT IMPACT

35% Target reward optimisation rate — users choosing the recommended method	₹150 Target additional reward value unlocked per user per month	+25 NPS Reward trust NPS improvement vs. control group target
---	---	---

North Star Metric: **Reward Discovery Rate** — the % of eligible transactions where users correctly identified the optimal payment method before paying. Target: 35% (vs. ~12% organic baseline).

